

Segmented worms

Worms in the “segmented worms” group have many different shapes, but their bodies are always divided into repeated units, or segments. Some burrow, while others crawl or swim. Some are parasitic.



Earthworms move through soil and leaf litter by expanding and contracting their segments in a sequence.



Predatory ragworms can crawl and swim with their leglike flaps. Their heads bristle with feelers.



Fan worms live in tubes and filter food from water using a retractable crown of tentacles.



Sea mice are covered with iridescent “fur.” They burrow through the seabed in search of prey.

These giant tube worms live only around deep-sea volcanic vents and grow up to 7¾ ft (2.4 m) long.



Echinoderms

Starfish and their relatives are called echinoderms, which means “spiny skin.” They are sea creatures covered with spines or knobs and are usually made of five equal parts. They move by snaking their arms or by creeping on their spines and tiny fluid-filled feet.



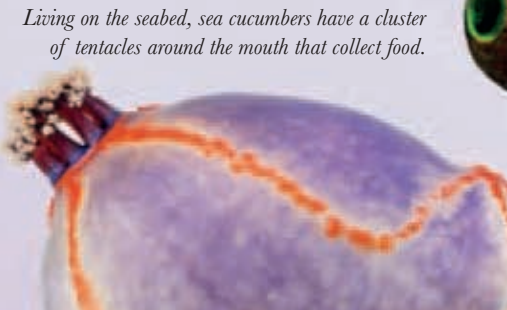
Beneath a starfish’s stiff arms are hundreds of tube feet. Starfish eat slow-moving or fixed animals, such as corals and clams.



Brittle stars have long, highly flexible arms, which they use to scavenge dead animals and waste on the seabed.



Sea urchins are algae-eating inhabitants of rocky shores and reefs. They are encased by a chalky covering with many spines.



Living on the seabed, sea cucumbers have a cluster of tentacles around the mouth that collect food.

Sea squirts

Adult sea squirts have bag-shaped bodies and live by filtering particles of food. Their young look like tadpoles, with a body stiffened by a rod, or notochord—a sign that they are closely related to vertebrates.

Sea squirts have a leathery body with openings for sucking in water and pumping it out. They often live in groups.

